

tial login. Let me know if you have any questions.

License Audit + Reallocation Steps

1. Communicate with users who have had a license for 6+ months. Start with an opt-in audit and remove licenses from inactive users.
1. Email the vendor with a list of users to be revoked from the platform. Confirm how many certifications remain on each license.
1. Add users who have been revoked from the platform to the revoked access tab. Fill in as much information about the user platform behavior as you have available.
1. The vendor will return an email with new signup codes. Update the license usage sheet with these codes and certification counts.
1. Restart the first time license allocation steps.

GCP Learning

As a GCP Partner, GitLab has unlimited seats to Google Cloud's Skills Boost Platform for Partners. This portal includes a wide array of learning materials related to Google Cloud's offerings, ranging from introductory to advanced.

This is a completely self-paced learning platform with a variety of learning formats, including video content and hands-on labs style engagement.

Sign Up

Any current GitLab team member can gain access to the learning platform by filling out this form. Required information includes your first and last name, your GitLab email address, a phone number, and your location. While it asks you to identify areas of interest, this is optional, and you are not limited to just the area of interest you've indicated.

Once you've submitted the form, you should receive a welcome email from partner-training@google.com within 1-3 business days with instructions for how to access the learning platform. If you don't receive an email try to sign-in to platform via Google. Once you gain access, all the learning content is available to you, and you can engage as much or as little as suits your individual learning goals and level of interest.

Certifications

Some learning paths are meant to give you knowledge and experience to pass a certification. To get the voucher code for passing a Google Cloud Certification please reach out to the learninganddevelopment slack channel.

Hone Learning

From January 2025, GitLab has partnered with the Hone employee development platform to provide licenses for all of GitLab's manager population. You can read more about the system and how to access, (including access or ICs) in the Hone handbook page.

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/work-with-us.md

Available Learning and Development Support

The Learning and Development team is available to support GitLab teams in the following capacities. Requests will be evaluated as they come in based on team's capacity for support, business impact, correlation to company OKRs, and number of impacted users.

Support Model	When to use this process
Hosting a Live Learning event	You'd like to host an internal Live Learning session
Creating a new learning pathway	Create a new learning pathway or course for any audience
Uploading to company learning platform	Add new or existing learning content to the LXP
Integrating external content to learning platform	Add off-the-shelf learning from another provider
Requesting content review	L&D review of your learning content for handbook first, adult learning theory, and bias for async alignment
Requesting new content creation	You'd like the L&D team to create or host learning content for your team

Creating a Learning Hub for your team

We work closely with leaders across GitLab to develop landing pages for learning material that is tailored to specific departments and teams. By creating learning hubs in Level Up, teams can contribute, curate, organize, and suggest professional development opportunities for their team members. Some scenarios where you might want to build a Channel include:

1. You have multiple LinkedIn Learning courses you'd like to showcase
1. You'd like to track what courses your team is completing
1. You'd like a single spot to send team members who are looking for professional development courses

To create new learning hub, open an issue in the lxp-contributions project using the learning-hub issue template.

Host a Live Learning event

Anyone at GitLab should feel empowered to host a learning session. Why would you want to host a live learning event? Maybe you are the expert on something. Or maybe you just want to learn more about a specific topic and share those learnings with more people.

To host a live learning event, start by opening an issue in the Learning and Development general project using the livelearning template. All steps should be outlined on this template.

Examples of past Live Learning events:

- Introduction to Coaching
- Being an Ally

Create a new course

Anyone team at GitLab is encouraged to build new courses. Some scenarios where you might want to build a pathway include:

1. Create career development path for your team.
1. Build a training for internal and/or external audiences on your role.
1. Develop a course that educates on remote work best practices.
1. Organize content you've found externally, like articles, videos, or podcasts.

Before you start the process to build content for a learning pathway, it's important that you ensure an existing pathway with the same content or style does not exist. Below are some strategies you can use to search existing content and check for duplication before you start building content.

After you've done a complete search of existing material that you can integrate into your pathway creation, you should start building the remainder of the content your pathway needs. When your content is built, open an issue on the lxp-contributions project using the lxpcontribution issue template.

Timeline and expectations

Action	Timeline
Build course content in the handbook	this is up to your team, but please build the content before opening a lxpcontributions issue
Open a lxpcontributions issue	5 weeks prior to launch
Start collaboration on pathway needs with L&D team	4 week prior to launch
Implement changes on handbook based on L&D feedback	3 weeks prior to launch
Complete Learning Evangelist training	L&D team will support team members 1:1 until this training is available again.
First iteration of content uploaded	2 weeks prior to launch
Peer or L&D review of content	1 week prior to launch
Make final edits based on peer review	1 week prior to launch
Launch your course	approx. 5 weeks after opening the lxpcontributions issue with the L&D team

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/career-development/_index.md

What is Career Development

Career development is the non-linear, lifelong growth process integrating learning, work, leisure, and change. It happens in all directions, including subject matter expertise, lateral growth to new teams, and linear growth through a job family. Use the resources on this page to navigate your career growth at GitLab.

Directory

Navigate to career development resources located throughout the GitLab handbook:

Resources and Tools

```
<div class="flex-row" markdown="0">
  <div>
    <a href="/handbook/total-rewards/benefits/general-and-entity-benefits/growth-and-development-fund" class="btn btn-primary" style="margin:5px;"> Growth and Development Fund</a>
    <a href="/handbook/people-group/learning-and-development/career-development/tracking-your-progress" class="btn btn-primary" style="margin:5px;">Goal Tracking Resources</a>
    <a href="/handbook/people-group/learning-and-development/career-development/having-career-conversations" class="btn btn-primary" style="margin:5px;">Career Development Conversations</a>
    <a href="/handbook/company/structure/job-frameworks" class="btn btn-primary" style="margin:5px;">Job Frameworks</a>
    <a href="https://levelup.gitlab.com/access/saml/login/internal-team-members?returnTo=https://levelup.gitlab.com/learn/course/igp" class="btn btn-primary" style="margin:5px;">How to use the IGP</a>
  </div>
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Career Growth Opportunities

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    <a href="/handbook/people-group/learning-and-development/internship-for-learning/" class="btn btn-primary" style="margin:5px;">Internship for Learning</a>
    <a href="https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1yY0ofMGgzN07yITAnRP5geFnWcgUYkiVlclyR54tpD0/editslide=id.g29a70c6c35068" class="btn btn-primary" style="margin:5px;">Career Development Workshop</a>
    <a href="/handbook/leadership/coaching/" class="btn btn-primary" style="margin:5px;">Work with a Coach</a>
    <a href="/handbook/people-group/learning-and-development/elevate-programs/" class="btn btn-primary" style="margin:5px;">Elevate Manager Training</a>
    <a href="/handbook/people-group/learning-and-development/self-paced-learning/linux-foundation-courses" class="btn btn-primary" style="margin:5px;">Linux Foundation Courses</a>
    <a href="/handbook/people-group/learning-and-development/self-paced-learning/oreilly-learning" class="btn btn-primary" style="margin:5px;">O'Reilly Learning</a>
    <a href="/handbook/people-group/learning-and-development/self-paced-learning/gcp-learning" class="btn btn-primary" style="margin:5px;">GCP Learning</a>
    <a href="/handbook/people-group/learning-and-development/growth-and-development/professional-developmentcertificationscourses" class="btn btn-primary" style="margin:5px;">Professional Certifications</a>
    <a href="/handbook/people-group/learning-and-development/growth-and-development/conferences-and-live-workshops" class="btn btn-primary" style="margin:5px;">Attend a Workshop/Conference</a>
    <a href="/handbook/people-group/learning-and-development/growth-and-development/academic-study" class="btn btn-primary" style="margin:5px;">Academic Study</a>
  </div>
</div>
```

[MR Coaching](/job-families/expert/merge-request-coach)

[TeamOps Certification](https://levelup.gitlab.com/access/saml/login/internal-team-members?returnTo=https://levelup.gitlab.com/learn/course/teamops)

[Individual Growth Plan Course](https://levelup.gitlab.com/access/saml/login/internal-team-members?returnTo=https://levelup.gitlab.com/learn/course/igp)

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Manager Training

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[Elevate](/handbook/people-group/learning-and-development/elevate-programs/)

[Support your Team with Career Conversations Course](https://levelup.gitlab.com/access/saml/login/internal-team-members?returnTo=https://levelup.gitlab.com/learn/course/support-your-team-with-career-conversations)

[Manager M Groups](https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/www-gitlab-com/-/issues/13409)

[Mitigating Risk Course](https://levelup.gitlab.com/access/saml/login/internal-team-members?returnTo=https://levelup.gitlab.com/learn/course/mitigating-risk)

[Manager M-Team Groups](https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/www-gitlab-com/-/issues/13409)

[Get to Know Yourself and your Team Course](https://levelup.gitlab.com/learn/course/getting-to-know-yourself-and-your-team)

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Job Shadow Programs

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[CEO Shadow](/handbook/ceo/shadow)

[Chief of Staff to CEO Shadow](/handbook/ceo/office-of-the-ceo/chief-of-staff-shadow)

[CFO Shadow](/handbook/finance/growth-and-development/cfo-shadow-program/)

[CMO Shadow](/handbook/marketing/cmo-shadow/)

[Security Team Shadow](/handbook/security/security-shadow/)

[Support Team Shadow](https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/support/support-team-meta/-/blob/master/.gitlab/issuetemplates/Support%20Shadow%20Program.md)

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Roles and Responsibilities

| Role | Responsibilities |

| ----- | ----- |

| Team Member Owned | - Take charge of your own development and career
 - Close the skill gap for current and future positions
 - Seize development and stretch opportunities
 - Remember there are no promises or guarantees of a promotion |

| Manager Facilitated| - Take time with team members to discuss their career aspirations
 - Listen and provide feedback, ideas and contacts
 - Make choices to support their development |

| GitLab Supported | - Communicate future direction and skills requirements
 - Provide information and tools when applicable
 - Communicate internal opportunities |

Self authorship and your career development

A live speaker series hosted in March 2022 with Lavinia Mehedintu gets to the 'why' of career development. Embrace your own self-authorship while using the following tools to fit your goals. In the session, Lavinia spoke about:

1. The impact of growth mindset on career development, and tips for shifting out of a fixed mindset

1. Trust building in an all remote space and the role that people managers play in building this trust

1. Learning and building out loud, sharing career development externally, and the power of social learning

{{< youtube "UsGITOmM2DM" >}}

70-20-10 Rule for Development

<div style="width: 100%;"><div style="position: relative; padding-bottom: 75.93%; padding-top: 0; height: 0;"><iframe frameborder="0" width="400" height="350" style="position: absolute; top: 0; left: 0; width: 100%; height: 100%;"

src="https://view.genially.com/62fd2aa9021efd0018b7c8eb" type="text/html"

allowscriptaccess="always" allowfullscreen="true" scrolling="yes"

allownetworking="all"></iframe> </div> </div>

1. 70% of your development should come from on-the-job and action learning. This can include development experiences like managing a project, serving on a cross-functional team, taking on a new task, job shadowing, job rotation, etc.

1. 20% of your development should come from interactions with others. This includes having a mentor, being a mentor, coaching, participating in communities of practice, providing and receiving feedback, serving as a leader in your organization, etc.

1. 10% of your development should come from training, including classes, seminars, webinars, podcasts, reading, conferences, etc. GitLab offers a growth and development fund to help with this.

Career Development versus Career Mobility

GitLab team members should not feel pressure to climb the career ladder. Skill development and promotion are not mutually exclusive. Unique experience influences problem solving and views of success.

You are encouraged to learn and develop skills without pressure to in turn seek promotion. Team members will not be thought less of or penalized if they don't view promotion as a success measure. If you feel you are not being supported in this way, please reach out to People Connect or your People Business Partner.

| Topic | Definition | Examples |

| ----- | ----- | ----- |

| Development | Choosing and building a career path that accelerates professional growth. |

Learn new skills, complete a course, be a mentee |

| Mobility | Career mobility involves both lateral (promotions) and horizontal (transfers)

movement along a career path. Mobility involves applying experience and skills as leverage for

a new role. | Mentor to learn leadership skills with the intention of applying for a manager

role; Complete a job shadow or internship and upskill to transfer to a new team. |

Career Development and Well-being

Watch this live speaker series where we talk to Leah Weiss of Skylyte about the connection between well-being, purpose, and our career growth.

{{< youtube "2XmmGYIsEP8" >}}

Document your Career Development

Individual Growth Plan

The Individual Growth Plan (IGP) is a tool to help you, the DRI of your career, plan and action on your career growth. It's a template to guide you through career goal setting and action planning. Think of the IGP template as a starting place, where you have the freedom to reflect on your career, answer and dive deeper on sections that help spark your interest and think differently about your career development.

The IGP can help with:

- 1. Setting and achieving learning goals
- 1. Keeping learning plans organized in one easy to share place that is used company wide
- 1. Preparing for promotions
- 1. Preparing for career transitions

Looking for a step-by-step guide on filling out the IGP? Use the resources below:

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Short Course: How to use the IGP

[Handbook: The GitLab IGP Guide](/handbook/people-group/learning-and-development/career-development/igp-guide/)

[Workday User Guide: Individual Growth Plans](https://docs.google.com/document/d/1qEqTHxG1uIPQi8rIlbrHjJ6S0NYhKDoHeBOLXsjkNw/edit)

Watch: interview with a GitLab team member who's used the Individual Growth Plan to plan a career transition at GitLab.

{{< youtube "0ih0IMoKxN0" >}}

Start your IGP

1. Launch your Individual Growth Plan in Workday: User Guide Here
1. Fill out the IGP in Workday. Refer to the job frameworks and your job family to determine a skill and behavior focus. Give yourself time to think, plan, and fill out your IGP. Set learning blocks over the next 1-2 weeks rather than completing the IGP in one sitting.
1. Submit your IGP to your manager. Schedule a career conversation with your manager and review your IGP in your next 1:1 or at a separate time.
1. Make a plan that integrates working on your IGP during the flow of work by setting aside weekly or monthly time dedicated to learning. Block these times on your calendar.
1. Update progress against your development goals. The IGP and development goals in Workday itself might work well for you, but if you need more structure, consider using GitLab Epics + Issues or a health tracker in Google Sheets.

Tracking your Progress

Accomplishment Tracker

Some call it a "brag sheet". Some call it a CREDIT Tracker. Either way, it's a great place to collect your accomplishments and feedback. Utilize the accomplishment tracker in conjunction with the IGP and GitLab Epics.

1. Make a copy of the Accomplishment Tracker Template + save to your drive
1. Start filling it out (check out the video below for a walkthrough) with links, notes, and screenshots
1. Set a weekly or monthly calendar reminder to continuously add to your tracker

Health Tracker: Growth Plan

Make a copy of this health tracker in Google Sheets and save it to your drive. Use it to track the current status and long term goals you've set for your growth.

Use GitLab Epics to track your career development

{{< youtube "xuisSgBQtaU" >}}

Epics are a great way to transparently and efficiently track your work and connect learning to

your results.

1. Open an epic in a personal or team project
1. Use the description to highlight your learning goals, ideal programs or resources you want to review, considerations when planning, etc.
1. Open issues to track actions you'll take as a result from things learned and resources used
1. Mark issues as related to your epic. Use a thread in the epic to link issues from different projects.
1. Refer to Example 1 and Example 2 for inspiration

Having Career Conversations

Compassionate and Results Oriented Career Conversations

{{< youtube "mpgqa4SHbVI" >}}

Watch the full conversation with Camilla Boyer at GitLab here

CREDIT and Career Conversations

Value	Career Conversations Application
Collaboration	Growth is led by individuals and supported by managers.
Results	Growth increases engagement with work which drives greater results.
Efficiency	Growth happens in the flow of work.
Diversity, Inclusion, and Belonging	Our experiences influence career motivations and the support we need.
Iteration	Motivation changes and promotes growth that is meaningful, interesting, and relevant.
Transparency	Trust enables vulnerability and support in reaching true career goals.

Having Career Conversations with your Manager

The video below is a recording of the Live Learning that took place in August 2021 as part of our Career Development Skill of the Month.

{{< youtube "JA3NNTGoELU" >}}

Having Career Development Conversations with your Team

Team Members: Take the Support your team with Career Conversations course in Level Up to review the material below!

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<div class="flex-row" markdown="0">
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    <a href="https://levelup.gitlab.com/access/saml/login/internal-team-
members?returnTo=https://levelup.gitlab.com/learn/course/support-your-team-with-career-
conversations" class="btn btn-primary" style="width:200px;margin:5px;">Take the Course</a>
  </div>
</div>
```

Manager responsibilities

During career conversations, managers:	Description
Listen	Understand career goals and unique challenges your team faces.
Are aware of bias	Recognize the power dynamic and unconscious bias that could be present.
Ask questions	Challenge and encourage your team to think critically about their career motivations and learning goals.
Surface resources	Share what you know, including internal and external resources, network connections, and suggested actions.
Suggest iterations	Encourage reassessment of goals and adjustments as needed.
Set expectations	Decide together the date of your next career conversations and the outcomes to achieve by that date.

Recommendations for Managers to support the learning of team members

Managers should support their direct reports with their professional development goals. Implement the following into a 1-1, team meeting, or async communication to support your team.

1. Encourage team members to create an Individual Growth Plan or use GitLab Epics to track their career development.
1. Utilize the Growth & Development Benefit.
1. Recommend (and model) blocking time to learn during the work week.
1. Organize team specific and cross-functional learning communities to practice social learning.
1. Model and share your own career and professional development pursuits.

Sample questions to ask your team:

1. Do you have any overused strengths or underdeveloped skills that might cause your career to stall or derail?
1. Considering feedback from others, are you perceived to have the skills required for the business needs of the future? If not, how could you shape that perception in a favorable direction?
1. How can you leverage your current skills and talents for your future aspirations?
1. What skills or talents are missing to qualify you for your future aspirations?
1. Does your feedback from others tell you anything about how feasible your aspirations are?
1. Do you currently have the skills and talents needed for the future business needs? If not what can you do now to get ready?

Inclusive Growth

It's critical to understand how the diverse experiences and perspectives of individuals influence their approach to career growth. Without the right support, behaviors by team members from underrepresented groups might influence their growth. Consider how the following might influence growth on your team

Behavior	Example
Raised Hands	Who opts in? Who doesn't? Who's your go to person for stretch projects? Lack

of opting in might be influenced by imposter syndrome, not a lack of interest. |
Starting the Conversation	Who already set up career conversations with you? Who hasn't? Like opting in, this could indicate different expectations of growth rather than disinterest.
Stretch Projects	Share equitably across your team. Be aware of who got the last opportunity. Ask open and honestly about everyone's interests and capacity before allocating stretch projects.
Beyond Work	Consider the jobs we have outside of work. These responsibilities might influence our career growth but do not have to limit it.
Cultural	Career growth expectations vary around the world. Ask your team individually about their expectations rather than making assumptions based on your experience.
Bias	Biases that might especially be prevalent in career conversations could include past roles and companies, performance, and authority.

Career Mapping and Development {career-mapping-and-development}

Aim to have career conversations with your team 2 times per year. Consider having these conversations in Q2 and Q4, aligning after talent conversations and planning for the next year.

This cadence is not required and can be adjusted as needed. Career conversations can happen during a regularly scheduled 1:1 or in a separate meeting.

Resources

Use the following templates to plan and prepare for career conversations with your team:

1. Career Conversation Agenda Template
1. Checklist for career conversation prep - Google Docs
1. Checklist for career conversation prep - GitLab Issue

Practice

What do managers ask about when it comes to having career conversations with their teams? Watch the short question and answer videos below to learn more. Watch the full training from 2021-08 [here](#).

Question	Answers from the GitLab Team
You started managing a team 6 months ago with 4 direct reports. One is performing well, but has not yet talked to you about career development. As their manager, What steps should you take?	< youtube "A4mfSgN3a5s" >
One of your direct reports has indicated they aren't interested in growing to the next level or developing further as they are happy in their current role. As their manager, what steps would you take?	

<td>{{< youtube "oALcZZWvkfl" >}}</td>
</tr>
<td>Your direct report has indicated they are ready to move to, and are already performing at, the next level. As their manager, what steps would you take?</td>
<td>{{< youtube "a2-InhVvM2M" >}}</td>
</tr>
<td>A direct report feels ready to move to the next level, but aren't fully performing in their current role. As their manager, what steps would you take?</td>
<td>{{< youtube "MuXQcorCVcs" >}}</td>
</tr>
<td>A career conversation becomes emotional - what do you do?</td>
<td>{{< youtube "sJRFS08V-Y" >}}</td>
</tr>
<td>How often do you have career conversations with your team?</td>
<td>{{< youtube "uFKoU53Vj8U" >}}</td>
</tr>
<td>What about team members who don't have strong sense of their career goals yet? How do you support them?</td>
<td>{{< youtube "pSAjpQxEx04" >}}</td>
</tr>
<td>What fears do managers at GitLab have when it comes to having career conversations?</td>
<td>{{< youtube "oHlrlAIRB7Y" >}}</td>
</tr>

Career Development Conversation Acknowledgements

Career Conversation Acknowledgements happen at a division basis. Check with your People Business Partner if your division is doing this.

Cadence

This process is just an acknowledgement by the team member that they have had career conversations. Aligned with the Performance/Potential matrix cadence, formal career conversations will ideally happen twice per year:

- Once in Q2
- Once in Q4

The bi-annual cadence is not required, but recommended. Some team members may prefer annual career conversations, other team members may prefer more informal check-ins quarterly. This is a personal decision that should be made between team member and manager. The minimal recommended cadence for career development conversations is annually, the most frequency

recommended cadence is quarterly.

Process

Please note that while managers can facilitate career development conversations with team members and help guide growth plans by using our internal resources, managers cannot complete the acknowledgement process for team members.

- This is not mandatory, however we highly encourage all team members to discuss their career goals with their manager.
- There is not one right way to document a career development conversation. Some team members may use their 1:1 document to capture the conversation and actions, others may use the tools provided above to help guide the conversation, or a team member may use their own personal template or process to have a career development conversation.
- If you have not had a career conversation yet it is up to you to schedule a time to review and discuss with your manager.
- If you are new to GitLab the recommendation is that you start career conversations after your first 90 days.
- Career conversations should not be confused with promotion conversations. Team members who do not want to increase their scope of work or be promoted, but are performing, should not feel pressured to move up or out. Career conversations can also focus on helping team members identify projects or other activities that keep the team member engaged and learning new skills. Please note that development can also include lateral moves, or moving to another specialty within the same job family and job level.

{{< youtube "xUNupnJyTNY" >}}

E-Group Performance Enablement Review

Each member of the E-Group will have a performance conversation with their direct manager, the CEO, at the beginning of the new fiscal year. These conversations will assess alignment to each of our credit values, performance and personal development.

The E-Group will follow a similar process to our GitLab team member process with the additional requirement of a self review.

Compensation Reviews

When conducting compensation reviews for the E-Group, GitLab will review two items:

1. Alignment to market rates
1. Performance factors

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/career-development/igp-guide.md

Your Role as the Driver of Your Career

You are the Directly Responsible Individual (DRI) of your career journey. This means you have

the power to make decisions that best serve your growth. This guide offers direction, not rigid rules. At its heart, your Individual Growth Plan is a personal tool to reflect, set goals, and take meaningful action.

After completing your IGP, the real magic happens when you commit to continuous learning:

- · Block dedicated calendar time for your development
- · Use this time for courses, certifications, stretch assignments, reading, or mentorship
- · Share your learning journey with your team, especially if you're a manager
- · Remember, when you prioritize your growth, you inspire others to do the same

Section 1: What Inspires You?

Self-reflection provides the compass for your career decisions. In this section, you'll explore these 5 key questions:

1. What parts of your role light you up and keep you engaged?
1. What work gives you that feeling of excitement and belonging?
1. Which areas of your work leave you feeling drained?
1. How do you learn best and most naturally?
1. Looking ahead 2-3 years, what role do you envision for yourself and why?

Be flexible with yourself here. You might choose to dive deep using tools like:

- Myers Briggs assessment
- Strengths Finder assessment
- Learning style exploration

Or you might prefer a simpler check-in approach. Both are perfectly valid!

Need inspiration? Listen to fellow GitLab team members share what energizes and drains them at work:

What brings you energy?

{{< youtube "vkFVwW-sovA" >}}

What depletes your energy?

{{< youtube "ST2IA-4iX-E" >}}

Stuck on these questions? Try this: Keep a simple energy journal for one week. Note when you feel energized or drained throughout your workday, then look for patterns to guide your reflection.

Section 2: Finding Your Focus

Understanding your desired growth direction helps you set meaningful goals and find the right resources. In this section, you'll clarify your role trajectory by answering these 3 questions:

1. Do you want to continue growing on your current team or explore something new?
1. Are you interested in managing a team or department someday?
1. Would you prefer developing specialized expertise as an individual contributor?

Dream big here! Consider various paths:

- Maybe you're curious about management
- Perhaps you're excited to deepen your expertise as an IC leader
- You might be ready for a career transition to a new team

Remember, at GitLab, career growth isn't limited to climbing a ladder. We grow in all directions!

Section 3: Setting Your Intention

Now that you've explored possibilities, it's time to get specific in Section 3. Looking toward your future, you'll articulate your medium-term goals by answering:

1. What specific accomplishments would help you reach your career objectives?
1. How will you recognize when you've been successful?

Here are some examples to spark your thinking:

Your Scenario	Your Accomplishments	Measuring Your Success
----	-----	-----
Exploring a Lateral Move	"I want to learn more about product management and develop the skills needed in that field."	"In 6 months, I'll be able to clearly articulate whether product management is a good fit for my career path."
Aspiring to Management	"I aim to develop the skills needed to become an effective people manager as part of my journey toward leading a functional area."	"I'll know I've succeeded when I'm confidently managing a team of 3 team members."
Growing as an IC	"I want to become a recognized technical expert in data integrations."	"Success means leading a data integration project for a key customer account."

Creating Your Development Goals

With your intentions set, it's time to create specific development goals that will help you reach your career objectives. Focus on 1-3 meaningful development goals per review period.

Make your goals concrete by considering:

1. What specific resources or support will help you succeed?
1. How does each goal connect to your broader career aspirations?
1. What actionable steps will you take to achieve each goal?
1. How will you engage your network for support and feedback?
1. What challenges might you face, and how will you address them?

Think creatively about your development using the 70-20-10 rule for development:

- 70% from challenging experiences and assignments
- 20% from relationships, networks, and feedback
- 10% from formal training and education

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```

Looking for development opportunities? Explore our resource repository of programs and learning platforms. Bookmark resources that align with your growth direction.

Pro Tip: If you can't find what you need internally, remember the Growth and Development Benefit can cover university programs, coding classes, external certifications, coaching, and more!

Bringing Your Plan to Life: Track, Reflect, and Adapt

Your IGP is a living document designed to evolve with you. Workday will remind you to review and refresh your IGP every 6 months after your manager provides input. Consider setting your own calendar reminders to stay on track.

Remember to update your development goals directly in Workday as you make progress. Here are ways to keep your IGP alive throughout the year:

1. Choose a format that works for you to track your progress. Check out these examples.
1. Schedule at least one quarterly career conversation with your manager during a 1:1.
1. Review your IGP before completing the Engagement Survey to provide informed feedback on your career growth.
1. Before participating in the 360 feedback program, review your IGP and ask for specific feedback on your development areas.
1. Include your growth journey and lessons learned in your Talent Assessments.

Here's a sample timeline to help you maintain momentum throughout the year:

When	Your Action	Helpful Resource
February	Review and refresh your IGP	Workday Guide: Launching an Individual Growth Plan
March - July	Update your goals as you make progress	Workday Guide: Updating Your Development Goals
August	Mid-year IGP review and refresh	Workday Guide: Launching an Individual Growth Plan
September - January	Continue updating goals with your progress	Workday Guide: Updating Your Development Goals

Resources to Support Your Journey

1. Watch this interview with a GitLab team member who used their IGP to successfully navigate a

career transition:

{{< youtube "0ih0IMoKxN0" >}}

1. Listen to team members share their experiences with non-linear careers at GitLab:

{{< youtube "ttQv6tCaDD0" >}}

1. If you're in Engineering, check out this Engineering-specific IGP Template that combines the Engineering Career Framework, Career Conversation Meeting Template, and Job Framework

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/elevate-programs/_index.md

Use the links below to navigate to each Elevate program. Here is a useful guide to ensure you're choosing the right program:

Program Name	Description
-----	-----
Elevate	For Managers and Senior Managers.
Elevate Applied	Continuous learning and resources for those who've earned their Elevate certification
Elevate+	For Directors and Senior Directors
ElevatePrep	For high potential ICs, or those on track to, or interested in, becoming a people manager.

If you have any questions about Elevate, or are interested in how you can participate in one of the programs, please reach out in the learninganddevelopment channel.

Elevate Feedback Loop

To remain ahead of the curve, GitLab Talent teams will utilize HPT (High Performing Teams) workshop data, Elevate program feedback, engagement survey data, and direct input from executive leadership to continuously up-level program content. Just as GitLab integrates customer insights into product development, the same holds true for Elevate design and future iterations. Similar product sensing mechanisms are used to guide continuous program improvement.

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/elevate-programs/elevate/_index.md

Elevate is a live virtual leadership development program for GitLab managers, focused on understanding leadership competencies, building emotional intelligence, giving and receiving great feedback, coaching, and recognizing unconscious bias.

Managers at GitLab enable our mission that everyone can contribute. We need to equip our people leaders with the skills to lead globally dispersed, all-remote teams to support our business growth at scale.

The handbook provides guidance on GitLab leadership competencies and principles. Bringing these practices to life requires training and practice. Elevate, GitLab's leadership development program, provides opportunity for people leaders to learn to lead at GitLab.

Goal

In FY26, 85% of GitLab managers will complete Elevate.

What team members are saying about Elevate

1. Much more confidence handling things when they go wrong. I react completely differently to situations now. Also I see myself as a manager whereas I didn't before and felt like I was making it up as I went.

1. I'm much more comfortable to give feedback using the frameworks we learned during the program. Also feel much more confident about my DNA as a manager by listening to others managers.

1. I now have an actionable set of tools available which helps me navigate any kind of conversation.

1. The different frameworks that were introduced are immensely helpful. I have been relying on them in numerous situations and find it to be really impactful.

What is Elevate

Elevate is a highly interactive, all-remote program where managers will learn with, and from, each other. The goal is to provide a common, well understood leadership framework which demonstrates GitLab values and leadership competencies.

In Elevate, participants will:

1. Practice the Manager & Leadership competencies

1. Build cross-functional relationships with coaching cohort members

1. Demonstrate leadership competency by completing the Elevate Leadership Certification

How is the program structured?

Elevate is organized into 6 learning modules, including 2 practice labs. Practice Labs are primarily an interactive session in which you'll practice the concepts taught in the previous module, however, every module will include elements of interactivity. Each module is 60 minutes long, and they take place at 2 week intervals. View the infographic below for more details on what's covered in each module. The session dates will be updated for the next cohort beginning in May soon.

All participants are expected to complete the program and make up any missed sessions within one month of the final live session taking place. If you think this won't be feasible, please let a member of the Learning and Development team know so we can find a solution, whether be providing extra support or re-adding you to the program at a later date.

We ask that team members make an effort to attend the live sessions, and engage in them fully,

with cameras on. This enhances the experience for other team members and fosters an environment which promotes more active engagement and discussion with the concepts being discussed.

Making up missed sessions

Attendance to all Elevate live sessions is required to complete the program. We understand that making time for all live sessions can be difficult. If you cannot attend one of the 2 scheduled private GitLab sessions, you will be able to schedule into a session publicly hosted by our delivery partner Hone. These sessions happen globally, so won't be exclusively GitLab team members, but the core concepts of the module will still be taught.

Supporting your team in Elevate

Engaging managers of people leaders in Elevate helps us to:

1. Engage managers and their direct reports in conversations about growth and development
1. Demonstrate leadership buy-in for manager development
1. Ensure participants have a line of communication with their manager to ask questions, raise concerns, and organize workload to participate in Elevate

People Leaders with direct reports who are in a current Elevate cohort could be asked to support in the following ways:

1. Notify team members of nomination and participation in Elevate during a 1:1 meeting and/or via Slack. Communications and timeline will be provided by the Learning and Development team.
1. Discuss the impact and benefits of Elevate during your 1:1. Answer questions that arise using this handbook page and direct further questions to the Learning and Development team.
1. If/when prompted by the Learning and Development team, follow up with reminders to team members who have missed live sessions or are not responsive to program communications.
1. Help team members manage their current workload and cohort timing.

Measuring Success

We evaluate the success of Elevate through a combination of surveys, sentiment scoring, feedback, and analysis of People data.

As we roll out the new iteration of the program, we are developing our methods for measuring success, and will add more information here soon.

Frequently Asked Questions

Is my participation in Elevate required?

Yes, this is a required training for all people leaders at GitLab.

Where do I communicate my questions, concerns, and feedback as I go through the program?

When the program begins, you'll be added to a Slack group that includes all members of your cohort. You can also reach out directly to your manager or the Learning and Development team.

I missed, or cannot attend, a session, what do I do?

It's a requirement to make up missed sessions to ensure that you're learning each new skill and moving through the program in the appropriate order. Please make every effort to attend live sessions as scheduled. If you miss a session, you'll have the option to schedule into a 'Membership' session in the Hone platform. We'll share more details on this process soon.

We're committed to working with you to find a solution that let's you successfully complete Elevate. If you must miss one live session for personal reasons, you need approval from your manager. Additional missed sessions will result in an incomplete Elevate status.

I'm over capacity and feel like I may need to opt out of the training, what should I do?

We want to try to support all people leaders to go through the program in its entirety - if you're feeling like it's too much to balance with your other work, as a first port of call please speak to your manager and explore options for how you can be supported to continue. If your manager is supportive of you leaving the program, please let one of the Talent Development team know. The Talent Development team will then speak to your People Business Partner to notify them of your leaving the program, and explore any final options to support you in continuing.

Team members who leave the program part way through will still need to complete it in its entirety in the future, but the point of re-entry will be reviewed on a case by case basis.

How often will this program run?

We currently plan for a new group of ~50 people leaders to start this program every 2-3 months.

Is there opportunity to participate in the program if I am an aspiring manager?

We're planning to launch ElevatePrep in Q1 of FY26, a program specifically designed for aspiring managers. Please reach out to the Talent and Development team in the learninganddevelopment if you wish to be considered for the next round. We'll be sharing more details on the program soon.

What if I get promoted while I'm part of Elevate?

If you're promoted from Manager to Senior Manager, you'll continue Elevate without interruption. If you're promoted to a Director role or above, please plan to discuss directly with your manager and the Elevate team. Decisions will be made on a case by case basis.

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/elevate-programs/elevate-applied/_index.md

Elevate Applied: Elevate Applied is a dynamic collection of resources aimed to extend leadership development and allow learners to apply concepts taught in Elevate and Elevate+ directly to their work. This includes custom live workshops, 1:1 coaching, job aids, team member resources, and self-paced courses. Resources are designed to help GitLab leaders focus on building and enabling high performing teams.

Apply what you learned in Elevate to build your high performing team.

Leaders at GitLab should feel supported with excellent resources to enable their practice, application, and integration of concepts taught in Elevate to their day to day work at GitLab.

To provide this support, the Talent Development team is launching Elevate Applied.

If you've had thoughts or questions like:

- 1. I could really use time to connect with other managers at GitLab and learn from their experience.
- 1. The GROW model sounds great - but I can't find opportunities to actually apply it.
- 1. I know how to give feedback to my team, but I'm not sure how or when to start.
- 1. How can I build stronger performance on my team?

... then Elevate Applied is for you.

Elevate Applied is an ongoing resource for Managers and Senior Managers at GitLab meant to strengthen leadership competencies, enable leaders to take action, and build connections between managers. It's a combined community and toolkit to help you build high performing teams.

Beginning in January 2024, the Talent Development team will begin this program with the ~130 managers who have earned their Elevate certification. We'll use data and feedback to inform and shape the future of manager training at GitLab.

Overview

All managers who earn their Elevate certification will be invited to participate. Participation is optional.

Each month, managers can expect to be served new resources and learning opportunities that are relevant to what is currently happening in the business. Some examples include:

- 1. Group coaching sessions
- 1. Self-paced Level Up courses
- 1. Templates and tools to assess and implement Elevate concepts and strategies
- 1. Organized calls to meet and discuss common challenges with other managers
- 1. Speaker sessions with internal and external experts

Topics

Below, you'll find a general outline of topics you can expect to learn about during each month:

Month	Topic
----	-----
January	Kickoff; Impacts of 1:1 Coaching
February	Using the Team Health Check
March	Coaching for High Performance
April	Practice Coaching Skills

Benefits

Throughout this program, managers can expect to:

1. Understand and use resources that help them apply concepts taught in Elevate, including:
 - Access to ongoing 1:1 coaching to support their growth in FY25
 - Coaching techniques to build a high performing team
 - Conversation strategies for giving and receiving feedback
 - Frameworks and templates for efficient career growth conversations
1. Expand their network and build upon existing relationships with other managers across the organization

Measuring Success

The Talent Development team will focus on the following metrics to measure success:

1. NPS score on self-paced coursework
1. Direct manager feedback
1. Aggregate and anonymous feedback from coaching partners

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/elevate-programs/elevate-applied/professional-coaching.md

Elevate Applied 1:1 Coaching is an opportunity for managers to work 1:1 with GitLab-trained professional coaches on specific skills. Eligibility is open to all people managers with priority given to applicants who have completed Elevate/Elevate+. This offering is covered by your Growth and Development Fund as a recommended coaching experience. Unlike other G&D submissions, participants will not cover costs up front; this will be directly billed to GitLab and covered by the G&D allocation for each participant.

Keep reading for information on the next Elevate Applied 1:1 Coaching Cohort.

Coaching for Accountability - FY25 Q2

GitLab managers use coaching to hold their teams accountable for great results.

Accountability is a key tenet of high performing teams at GitLab. Participants will hone their skills in managing their "inner fixer", asking powerful questions, utilizing the GROW model, and demonstrating active listening to elevate their leadership capabilities. Coaches will guide participants to apply their own coaching skills in ensuring their team's success.

Here's what to expect:

1. Apply: Complete a short application. Responses shared in your application will be used to pair you with a coach with the right skillset, experiences, and timezone that work for you.
1. Community: You'll join a Slack channel of nine (9) other leaders meeting with coaches on the same topic and share your discoveries and best practices.
1. 1:1 Coaching: You'll spend a total of 4 hours with your coach. Session 1 will be 60 minutes

and will focus on getting to know, and building trust with, your coach. Then, choose to schedule 30 or 60 minute sessions for the remaining 3 hours, where you'll focus on coaching skills that will enable you to hold your team accountable for great results.

1. Feedback: The GitLab L&D team will check in with you after your last session to gather feedback

During 1:1 coaching, you'll practice the following skills and plan to apply them to current accountability challenges on your team:

Participant Requirements

Managers who meet the eligibility requirements below are invited to apply. The cost of this program is \$2,100 USD. Accepted participants will use their Growth and Development funds to cover the program cost.

- 1. Currently in a people manager role at GitLab
- 1. Have sufficient Growth and Development funding remaining for FY25 to cover program cost
- 1. Not currently paired with a professional coach from Coaching Right Now
- 1. Priority given to people managers who have earned an Elevate or Elevate+ certification

Apply

Applications will open from 2024-06-05 through 2024-06-14. Use this [Google Form](#) to apply. The application should take less than 10 minutes to complete.

Read testimonials below from managers who have received professional coaching from GitLab.

Selection Criteria

The Coaching for Accountability cohort in FY25 will include 10 participants who will be selected based on the following criteria:

- 1. Demonstration of interest and investment in growth from application notes
- 1. Diversity in region, gender, race, ethnicity, tenure at GitLab
- 1. Recommendations by People Business Partners

If you are not accepted into the FY25 cohort, consider these options for future coaching opportunities:

- 1. Remain on the waitlist and be notified of future Elevate Applied coaching offerings
- 1. Use your Growth and Development fund to meet with a professional coach

Timeline

Date Action
----- -----

2024-06-05	Applications Open
2024-06-14	Applications Close
2024-06-21	Selected participants notified
2024-07-15	Coaching Begins
2024-09-30	Coaching Ends
2024-09-30	Participant feedback collected

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/elevate-programs/elevate-prep/_index.md

ElevatePrep is a signature program within GitLab's broader Elevate leadership experience aim to enhance leadership performance and capability across the organization. ElevatePrep focuses on skills and capabilities that strengthen self-awareness, goal setting, feedback, and influencing others. This experience is designed for GitLab individual contributors (ICs) who would like to one day step into a people management role or lead multifaceted, cross-functional projects more effectively. ElevatePrep lays the foundation for strong professional skills that support a variety of goals.

Important Note About Career Development

While ElevatePrep provides valuable leadership development opportunities, participation in the program is neither a guarantee of promotion nor a prerequisite for moving into a people leadership role at GitLab. The program is designed to support professional growth and skills development, regardless of your chosen career path.

What is ElevatePrep

ElevatePrep is a highly interactive, all-remote (live virtual learning) program where participants develop leadership skills that are valuable in both IC and people leadership roles. The program provides practical frameworks and tools that align with GitLab values while developing skills that support collaboration and influence across the organization.

In Elevate Prep, participants will:

1. Develop skills that enhance their current IC role
1. Build cross-functional relationships with cohort members
1. Learn fundamental leadership competencies and expectations of people managers at GitLab
1. Explore aspects of people leadership at GitLab

How is the program structured?

ElevatePrep consists of 4 core learning modules, each focusing on essential professional development areas:

1. Take control of your career path: Learn to create meaningful development plans and navigate your professional growth
1. Get Feedback that Improves your Performance: Develop skills to provide and receive effective feedback
1. Give Feedback that Lands: Build confidence in delivering honest feedback and have direct

conversations with anyone

1. Influence without authority: Learn to drive results through influence and effective stakeholder management

Each module is 60 minutes long and delivered live through our learning portal (in partnership with Hone). The program brings together cohorts of approximately 25 participants to ensure meaningful interaction and discussion.

All participants are expected to complete the program and make up any missed sessions within one month of the final live session taking place. If you think this won't be feasible, please let a member of the Learning and Development team know so we can find a solution, whether be providing extra support or re-adding you to the program at a later date.

Program Requirements

To successfully complete ElevatePrep, participants must:

1. Complete all four (4) live learning sessions
1. Actively participate in discussions and exercises
1. Engage with cameras on during sessions to foster better interaction

Eligibility and Nomination Process

Participation in Elevate Prep requires:

1. Manager approval
1. Active interest in developing leadership skills
1. Ability to commit to all four sessions

While team members can express interest in participating, preference is given to those nominated by their managers. This helps ensure participants have the support needed to fully engage in the program.

Making up missed sessions

Attendance at all live sessions is required to complete the program. If you cannot attend one of the scheduled GitLab sessions, you will be able to schedule into a public offerings hosted by Hone. We'll share more information on SAFE best practices when joining public sessions. These sessions happen globally, so won't be exclusively GitLab team members, but the core concepts of the module will still be taught.

Supporting your team members in ElevatePrep

Managers with team members participating in ElevatePrep should:

1. Discuss the program's benefits and expectations during 1:1 meetings
1. Support team members in managing their workload to accommodate program participation
1. Provide ongoing encouragement and opportunities to apply learned skills

1. Help ensure participants can attend all sessions

Measuring Success

We evaluate the success of Elevate Prep through participant feedback, skill application, and program completion rates. Specific success metrics will be developed as we gather data from initial cohorts.

Frequently Asked Questions

Does participating in ElevatePrep guarantee a future management role?

No. While the program develops valuable leadership skills, participation does not guarantee promotion or placement in a management role. Career progression at GitLab is based on multiple factors including business need, performance, and demonstrated competencies.

How often will this program run?

Program scheduling is based on organizational needs and demand. Details about upcoming cohorts will be shared through the Learning & Organizational Development team (Talent Development). Join our [learninganddevelopment](#) slack channel for updates on ElevatePrep and other GitLab learning offerings.

How do I express interest in participating?

Speak with your manager about your interest in the program. They can nominate you for participation in an upcoming cohort.

What if I miss a session?

Completion of all sessions is required for program completion. If you must miss a session, you'll have the option to make it up through Hone's membership sessions. We'll provide specific details about the makeup process when the program begins.

Where do I communicate questions or concerns about the program?

When the program begins, you'll be added to a dedicated Slack group for your cohort. You can also reach out directly to your manager or the Learning and Development team in the [learninganddevelopment](#) channel.

Is ElevatePrep a prerequisite for the main Elevate program?

Not exactly. ElevatePrep and Elevate are designed for different levels of leadership and experience. ElevatePrep is for ICs interested in growing skills to promote strong people management, while Elevate is a requirement for all people managers and requires some level of people management/people leadership experience. Later this year (FY26), we are exploring options on how we may allow ElevatePrep alum to gain entry into Elevate cohorts.

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/elevate-programs/elevateplus/_index.md

Elevate+: a live virtual leadership development program for leaders of leaders at GitLab, focused on strengthening leadership identity, mastering GitLab business acumen, building and executing team strategy, maintaining effective cross-functional partnership, and efficient change management.

Leaders at GitLab enable our mission that everyone can contribute. We need to equip our people leaders with the skills to lead globally dispersed, all-remote teams to support our business growth at scale.

This page outlines the current format of Elevate+, for participants enrolled in Cohorts 1 through 6.

Through small group cohorts and interactive workshops, Elevate+ is designed to enable senior leaders at GitLab to better understand and practice behaviours anchored in GitLab's values and leadership competencies, develop new skills to support high priority business needs, and help establish and strengthen cross-functional connections.

Elevate+ will create a shared leadership development experience across the organization so that every leader has a solid capability to lead in alignment with our GitLab values. This program will focus on the leadership behaviors required to build high performing teams that deliver results for customers.

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style="position:absolute;top:0;left:0;width:100%;height:100%;" title="Welcome to
Elevate+"></iframe></div><script src="https://player.vimeo.com/api/player.js"></script>
```

In Elevate+, participants will:

1. Understand and practice behaviors and frameworks anchored in GitLab's values and leadership competencies
1. Apply new skills to support their highest priority business needs
1. Build cross-division relationships and learning through small group cohorts
1. Collaborate with stakeholders to integrate their learnings into their day-to-day work in order to tackle real challenges
1. Take action on feedback from their team, leader, and cross-functional stakeholders to map out your and your teams' future growth

Participant Hub

Are you an active participant in Elevate+? Click here to navigate to the Participant Hub with relevant links and resources!

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development/elevate-programs/elevateplus/participant-hub/" class="btn btn-primary"
```

[Click Here: Participant Hub](#)

Time Commitment

Step	Week	Title	Description	Time
1	1	Live Learning Session (Zoom)	Cross-functional synchronous learning session on the relevant module topic	50 minutes
2	2, 3	Asynchronous Intersession work (GitLab)	Asynchronous assignment to reinforce concepts learned in the Live Learning Session and support participants in advancing their identified business goals. Each assignment will include conversations led by participant with identified individuals in order to directly apply new concepts and a documented deliverable due prior to the Live Cohort Workshops	75 minutes
3	4	Live Cohort Workshop (Zoom)	Cross-functional synchronous cohort workshop sessions with ~8-10 other GitLab people leaders to review Intersession work, give and get feedback on application of concepts, and additional opportunities for practice	80 minutes
4	5	Share Module Feedback (Google Forms)	Share your perspective on the Elevate+ program by providing input about each module	5 minutes

Throughout the program, participants will also revisit and adapt their ReadMes, crystallizing their focus on leadership development and the ways in which they contribute to GitLab's business.

Pre-Certification Coaching

After you complete Module 5, attend a pre-certification coaching session to prepare for certification.

The intention of this session is to allow space to practice and ask questions about what certification will look and feel like.

In preparation for the pre-certification session, please review the certification scoring rubric, the GROW coaching model, and the certification scenarios.

During the session, you can expect the following:

1. Review the criteria for peer evaluation and calibrate on the scoring scale you will use during the certification